

THEROS BEYOND DEATH

STORY ON CARDS

Posted on December 16, 2019

The story of Theros is a tale for the ages, and one not to be missed. So, as we move through Theros Beyond Death previews, certain cards will come with a bit of flavor, worldbuilding, or important story moments. We'll collect those story moments right here.

PREVIOUSLY, ON THEROS . . .

To fight the sun god Heliod, the forge god Purphoros created a sword capable of damaging the divine. The two gods battled, disrupting the celestial resting place of an ancient and powerful hydra: Polukranos, World Eater. Enraged, the hydra stormed through the mortal realm of Theros until it was sealed by Heliod and the hunt god Nylea.

The Planeswalker Elspeth arrived in Theros during the climax of Heliod and Purphoros's battle. She saw Purphoros' sword flung from his hands, and planeswalked away with it. She returned to Theros fifteen years later and faced an angry Heliod. But the god regained his bearings and realized Elspeth could help him, so he reformed the sword into the spear Godsend. Wielding this weapon, Elspeth was able to defeat the newly awakened Polukranos.

Meanwhile, the satyr Planeswalker Xenagos had hatched a plan to ascend to godhood. By cultivating belief and devotion among his followers, he was able to transcend mortality and join the other gods in their home of Nyx. Xenagos planned to use his new status for ill, so Elspeth vowed to stop him. She journeyed to Nyx and stabbed Xenagos with Godsend, destroying him once and for all.

Fearful of her power and knowledge of the multiverse, Heliod stabbed Elspeth with her very own weapon, which shattered afterwards. Dying, Elspeth's soul became trapped in the Underworld of Erebos where it remains . . . for now.

NOW, WE RETURN TO THEROS . . .

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ELSPETH, SUN'S NEMESIS

Dying on Theros doesn't mean your story is over, and Elspeth's next chapter is just beginning. Something has been disturbing her well-deserved rest in Ilysia—and what's up with that strange black spear?



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ASHIOK, NIGHTMARE MUSE

Ashiok continues to spread a unique brand of nightmares throughout Theros. Not even the Underworld is safe from such dark power, and Elspeth's twisted memories are all too delicious for Ashiok to ignore.



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ATHREOS, SHROUD-VEILED

Athreos is the god responsible for taking the dead across the Rivers That Ring the World and into the Underworld. When he lays his staff across the water of one of the five rivers, it becomes a boat to carry the dead.

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KLOTHYS, GOD OF DESTINY

The god of destiny, Klothys, does not appreciate those who would manipulate fate—and her response is swift and final. If a certain someone were to attempt to escape the Underworld, Klothys would do everything in her power to stop them...

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THE BINDING OF THE TITANS

Thousands of years ago, the gods waged war against the titans, their predecessors. Victorious, the gods sealed the titans in the underworld. If they were ever freed, they would inflict unspeakable horrors on Theros.

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EREBOS, BLEAK-HEARTED

Erebos rules the Underworld with an iron whip. Jealous, tyrannical, and paranoid, Erebos creates monsters to guard his realm. Despite his proclivities, he and Elspeth have a foe in common — the sun god, Helioid.

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UNDERWORLD BREACH

The gods are at war, and their strife can lead to unintended consequences. One of those consequences is the opening of rifts connecting the Underworld to the mortal realm — allowing Erebos' monsters to pour forth and sow chaos.



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WOE STRIDER

Some souls in the underworld become twisted and hateful over the course of their afterlife. The most evil and malicious of them all transform into horrible monsters—like the Woe Strider here.



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PHARIKA'S SPAWN

When the god Pharika first attempted to create the gorgons, she made creatures much too dangerous for her to control. They were banished to the Underworld, now used by Erebos to keep souls where they belong.



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OX OF AGONAS

There is a legend in Agonas of a fallen warrior who was able to tame a wild ox and ride it all the way to Nyx. Condemned souls who seek this freedom instead find themselves tangled for eternity in the ox's twisted horns.



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ESCAPE VELOCITY

Keranos, the god of storms, has little time for the souls of foolish mortals. But if someone in the Underworld manages to impress him, Keranos may bless them with a fraction of his power. This, too, must be used wisely.



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GLIMPSE OF FREEDOM

The Labyrinth of Memories is a maze of waterways in the Underworld that traps travelers by sending them in circles for eternity. Sirens torment lost souls by whispering true directions — words that fade immediately from the listener's mind.



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HELIOD, SUN-CROWNED

Heliod once employed Elspeth as his champion, even crafting her a weapon. Terrified of her power, he stole the spear back and struck her down into the Underworld. He still fears her to this day.



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DRAG TO THE UNDERWORLD

Erebos's whip is impossibly long, like a thin shadow that stretches on forever. Any stubborn souls who refuse to cross into the Underworld find themselves wrapped in its coils and dragged into the depths.



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NYLEA'S INTERVENTION

When the gods clash, Nylea, god of the hunt, brings force in numbers. Even the most fearsome monsters of the land are at her beck and call.



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STORM'S WRATH

When you anger Keranos, the god of storms, the results can be... predictable. Shocking, we know.



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HELIOD'S INTERVENTION

The symbol of Heliod's power is his spear, Khrusor. Such is its power that Heliod can strike any point on Theros at any time. It is a powerful weapon that has had no equal — until now.

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RISE TO GLORY

For some time, Daxos has been a Returned — a soulless creature wandering the plane. After great effort, Helios was able to restore Daxos's soul — but he demands a favor in return.

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RENATA, CALLED TO THE HUNT

For her champion, Nylea has selected Renata — a legendary hunter from Theros's past. It is said that when Renata threw her spear, she could hit a boar half a mile away.

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TYMARET, CHOSEN FROM DEATH

The gods are clashing, and they have each selected a champion. Erebos has chosen Tymaret, the warlike leader of the Returned, to become a demigod and serve as the leader of his forces.

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ANAX, HARDENED IN THE FORGE

Anax was once the legendary king of Akros, but today, he is Purphoros's champion in the war between the gods. Reforged to think of nothing but victory, he nonetheless repeats a single name: "Cymede."

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CALLAPHE, BELOVED OF THE SEA

In life, Callaphe was the most skilled mariner to ever sail the seas. She once gained Thassa's respect by outmaneuvering her krakens — and because of that respect, Thassa chose Callaphe as her champion.

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DAXOS, BLESSED BY THE SUN

Restored and empowered by Heliod, Daxos was given a single command: erase all signs of the other gods in Meletis. He and Elspeth were once a couple, but he has no choice but to obey his god.



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URO, TITAN OF NATURE'S WRATH

Uro, the most solitary of the titans, feels most at home on the ocean floor. If he were to rise from beneath the waves, all ships on the sea would capsize. Thankfully, he has been sealed in the Underworld for eons.



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KROXA, TITAN OF DEATH'S HUNGER

Kroxa is possessed by a never-ending hunger. If he ever escaped his confinement in the Underworld, he would eat all of Meletis in a single afternoon — then head to Nyx for dessert.



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FATEFUL END

Those who attempt to defy fate soon learn the god of destiny has a wrathful side. Her fury is swift and final — those who defy her find themselves wound in the strings of fate.



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FURIOUS RISE

Klothys has been absent from the pantheon of the gods for quite some time. Though Xenagos tried (and briefly succeeded) to take her place, she has risen again to claim what is rightfully hers.



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DESTINY SPINNER

Klothys, bound to the Underworld, is not able to pursue those who escape. In her place, she sends Agents of Fate to make sure events pass as they should. The Agents wield Klothys's thread in pursuit of their goals.



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CALIX, DESTINY'S HAND

Calix was created as an Agent of Fate specifically to reweave Elspeth into the pattern — but her irrational desire to be free of eternal peace confounds him. Created by Klothys, something must happen to ignite his spark...



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AGONIZING REMORSE

In her dreams, Elspeth is haunted by the shadows of her past. While this should be impossible in Ilysia, something (or someone) causes her to remember her loves, regrets, and death — every single night.



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ELSPETH'S NIGHTMARE

Each night in her dreams, Elspeth relives her traumatic past. Witnessing those nightmares, Ashiok learns of the Phyrexians — and is thrilled to discover that such real, living horrors exist in the multiverse.

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SHADOWSPEAR

Reliving her death every night, Elspeth is able to seize the shadow of Helioid's spear, Khrusor, from her nightmares and bring it into the waking world — a dark weapon to pierce through the Underworld and into the light.

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TRIUMPHANT SURGE

In her escape from the Underworld, Elspeth finds many opportunities to wield the Shadowspear. Victory after victory, she declares to onlookers that her spear is the real Khrusor and Heliod's is a fake.

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RELENTLESS PURSUIT

Created only to pursue and defeat Elspeth, Calix is a master tracker with a one-track mind. His powers over fate not only help him influence the future — they also allow him to read the past.

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ELSPETH CONQUERS DEATH

As the legend of Elspeth's spear grew, Khrusor's strength waned. When she finally battled Helioid at the gates of the Underworld, his spear shattered in his hands. Pleased by Helioid's defeat, Erebus allowed Elspeth to return to the land of the living.

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HELIOD'S PUNISHMENT

Outwitted and overpowered, Helioid is defeated by Elspeth in the Underworld. Erebus, triumphant in his eons-long battle, seals Helioid—trapping him for eternity beneath a giant boulder.

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SHATTER THE SKY

When the gods clash, it is often the mortals of Theros who must bear the consequences. They will rebuild, as they always rebuild, and they will pray — a little less out of piety, and a little more out of fear, but they will pray.

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